Sukanya Samriddhi

Scheme Name: Sukanya Samriddhi Account Scheme (SSA)

Ministry / Department:
Department of Economic Affairs, Ministry of Finance, Government of India. Operated through post offices and authorised banks.

Purpose:
Sukanya Samriddhi Account promotes savings for the education and marriage expenses of a girl child.

Benefits:
- Account can be opened in the name of a girl child before she attains 10 years of age.
- Minimum deposit is Rs. 250 in a financial year.
- Maximum deposit is Rs. 1.5 lakh in a financial year.
- Deposits qualify for deduction under Section 80C of the Income Tax Act.
- Interest earned is exempt from income tax as per scheme information.
- Withdrawal is allowed for higher education as per rules.
- Premature closure is allowed for marriage after the account holder turns 18, subject to rules.
- Account matures after 21 years from opening.

Eligibility:
- Girl child resident Indian citizen at the time of opening.
- Account is opened by guardian.
- Only one account can be opened in the name of one girl child.
- Account can be opened in post offices and authorised banks.

Documents Commonly Required:
- Birth certificate of girl child.
- Aadhaar / identity proof of guardian.
- Address proof of guardian.
- Photograph.
- Initial deposit.

Where to Apply:
- Post office.
- Authorised bank branch.
- Official information: https://www.nsiindia.gov.in

Common Citizen Issues:
- Annual minimum deposit not made.
- Transfer from one post office/bank to another.
- Withdrawal for education.
- Closure at marriage.
- Interest rate confusion because rates are notified by Government from time to time.

RTI Department / Office:
Public Information Officer, Department of Economic Affairs or National Savings Institute for scheme-level information. Account-specific records are held by the concerned post office or bank.

Official Source: